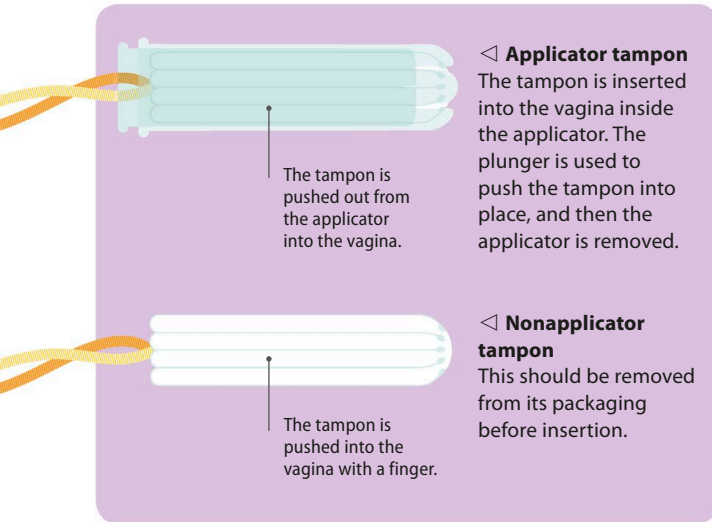


Tampons

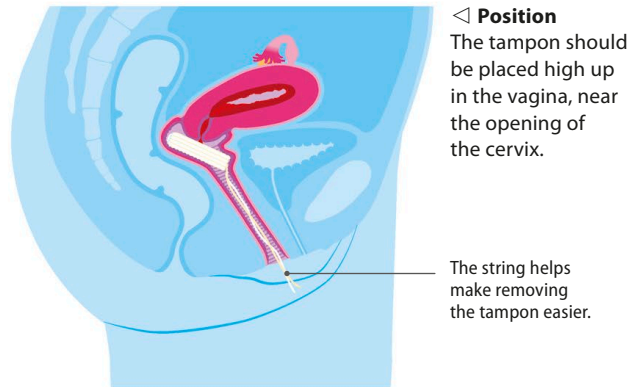
A tampon is a small, compact roll of soft material that is placed inside the vagina to soak up menstrual blood. Tampons must be changed about every four to six hours. There are different sizes and absorbancies available, according to whether a period is light, medium, or heavy.



GOOD TO KNOW

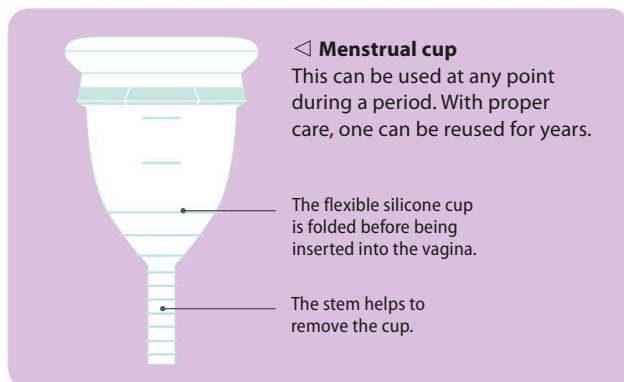
Toxic shock syndrome (TSS)

TSS is a rare but dangerous condition that may cause flu-like symptoms, a high temperature, and a rash. It is caused by toxins produced by bacteria that can build up in the vagina when using a tampon. To reduce the risk, change tampons every four to six hours, always wash your hands before insertion and removal, and use the lowest size and absorbancy for the heaviness of your period.



Menstrual cups

Made of flexible silicone, a menstrual cup is a reusable product worn inside the vagina to collect menstrual blood, rather than absorb it. During a period, it needs to be emptied, rinsed, and replaced every four to eight hours. At the end of a period, it should be washed with unscented soap and water, and stored in a clean place. The sizes are not related to menstrual flow, but to the user's age and whether or not she has given birth.



MYTH BUSTER

The truth about menstrual care

You'll still be a virgin if you use a tampon or menstrual cup. A virgin is a person who hasn't had sex.

A tampon or menstrual cup can't get lost. The cervix is too small for a tampon or menstrual cup to pass through.

